

LIFE OF AN INTERNET TROLL

An internet troll is indeed a special type of creature. Being right all the time,

coming up with innovative insults, firing off inflammatory comments and countless sleepless nights are bound to take a troll... er we mean toll right?

<http://bit.ly/digit6115>

INTEL PROMISES X86-BASED PHONES IN 2012

An announcement like this can result in many sleepless nights for the founders of ARM; currently owners of the IP behind the only other processor mobile architecture. Currently the x86 architecture is too power intensive and can't compare. Read more <http://bit.ly/digit6118>

HTML 5 TO TRANSFORM ONLINE VIDEO

HTML 5 promises to serve and playback hardware-accelerated video all in a browser irrespective of where its running; whether on a tablet, on an embedded device, and all without loads of intricate coding. Learn how HTML5 Will Transform the Online Video Landscape <http://on.mash.to/digit6119>

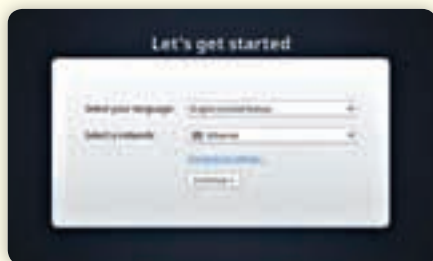
SONY 'WELCOMES BACK'

Sony wants to apologise for the recent PSN outage through its "welcome back" campaign that aims to tempt distraught PSN users with free games and good vibes. The gesture may well prove too little, too late for many disgruntled users. Read the comments in this Engadget update <http://engt.co/digit6120>

The other option, if you've built Linux before, is to build Chromium OS from source (<http://bit.ly/lEtEmwj>). It's fairly easy; it requires an Ubuntu install, and about an hour to download and build. You can do it from inside VirtualBox, too, if you don't have a Linux build environment set up.

Write to Memory Stick and Boot Up Chrome OS

The next step is to burn Hexxeh's Chrome OS image onto your USB memory stick. Windows users should use Image Writer



(<http://bit.ly/Dchrome1>); Mac users should use dd; and Linux users should use the usb-imagewriter package (<http://bit.ly/Dchrome2>).

Once you've completed the imaging process, plug your USB memory stick into your soon-to-be-Chromebook, power on, and hopefully the Chrome OS boot sequence will begin! If it doesn't, you may have to enter BIOS and make sure your computer is set to boot from USB. If the boot process fails entirely, try another one of Hexxeh's builds.

After about 8 seconds, you should be greeted with a login screen that looks like the image above.

If a network connection has been detected – WiFi or Ethernet – you'll be able to continue to the login screen. Enter

your normal Google account credentials and press Enter. If Chrome OS has detected a built-in webcam, you'll have the option of taking a photo of your ugly mug for the login carousel; you can click Skip if you'd rather have a faceless avatar, though.

Once you're through the photo-taking, you'll be presented with a very plain-looking Chrome browser window. You've made it – you're now using Chrome OS!

Installing to Hard Drive or SSD

Your Chromebook will very happily boot from your USB memory stick – but let's face it, you don't really want an ugly dongle sticking out of your netbook, just waiting to be pulled out by an angry girlfriend or clipped on a doorway. Fortunately, installing Chrome OS to a hard disk drive or solid-state drive is easy.

Warning: this will completely wipe the contents of your HDD or SSD, so proceed with caution.

First, hit Ctrl+Alt+T, which will bring up a diagnostic-type terminal screen.

Then, type shell and press Enter

Type /usr/sbin/chromeos-install and press Enter. If prompted for a password, use facepunch

When the install process finishes, reboot your computer, pull out your memory stick,

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Welcome to crosh, type 'help' for a list of commands.
crash> shell
chrome@localhost: / $ /usr/sbin/chromeos-install
```

wait 8 seconds, and voila: Chrome OS running from your hard drive. It might even boot in under 8 seconds, if you're using an SSD.

Conclusion and Caveats

What you have just installed is Chromium OS, not Chrome OS. Like the Chromium and Chrome browsers, the OSes are very similar, but not quite the same. Two of Chrome OS's best features – Verified Boot and Easy Recovery – don't exist in Chromium OS. Likewise, Chrome's built-in PDF reader doesn't exist in Chromium OS, and embedded MP3 playback requires some tweaking (<http://bit.ly/Dchrome3>) – but it does come with a Flash Player plug-in!

More importantly, though, Chromium OS can run every Chrome web app and extension. You'll notice that Hexxeh's Vanilla builds don't come with any bundled apps or extensions, so your first port of call should be the Chrome Web Store. After that, you should set up Google Cloud Print, connect to Google Music (if you have a beta invite!), and then, well... the web's your oyster!

Finally, if you're having any problems – even though Chromium OS isn't officially supported – Google's Chromebook support pages are a great starting point. There are excellent guides on setting up user accounts and tweaking settings and there's a complete list of keyboard shortcuts, too. For more in-depth how-tos and troubleshooting, check out the Chromium OS developer resources (<http://bit.ly/Dchrome4>).

